JON-AIR (REV8) MINI-AIRBOAT

Purpose-Built Shallow-Water Workboats for Everglades Invasive Species Mitigation

THE MISSION: MISSION-DRIVEN EVERGLADES CONSERVATION

The invasive Burmese python is destroying native wildlife across the Florida Everglades. Standard commercial airboats sit high, ride loud, and lack the maneuverability required for tight sawgrass channels. **Jon-Air rev8** is a specialized, low-center-of-gravity workboat engineered specifically for volunteer hunters to navigate, spot, and eradicate invasive species efficiently.

1. PURPOSE-ENGINEERED DESIGN FEATURES

Low-CG Sightline Advantage

Mounting the Rotax 850 E-TEC engine low in the hull and lowering the seating position places the operator near water-level line-of-sight. This facilitates spotting pythons under bank overhangs and dense grass lines.

Armored 1448 Aluminum Hull

Built upon a heavy-duty 1448 aluminum Jonboat foundation armored with continuous UHMW plastic bottom plating, allowing seamless gliding over dense sawgrass without hull damage or sticking.

117-Degree Hard Chine

Features a specialized 117-degree hard-chine hull profile delivering straight-line tracking at speed through narrow marsh tracks, compensating for roll stability alongside the low center of gravity.

Silent Drift & Hybrid Oars

Equipped with integrated custom oar locks to enable motor-off silent drifting through sensitive hunting corridors, paired with rapid ~3.5s hole-shot power when engine thrust is needed.

2. TECHNICAL PERFORMANCE MATRIX

SPECIFICATION	JON-AIR REV8 PARAMETER	OPERATIONAL BENEFIT
Powerplant	Rotax 850 E-TEC (165 HP class)	High power-to-weight ratio for rapid marsh acceleration.
Hole Shot	~3.5 seconds to plane	Instant lift in shallow water without bottoming out.
Top Speed	30+ mph	Rapid transit between high-priority hunting zones.
Bottom Armor	Full-coverage UHMW PE sheet	Puncture resistance over mud, cypress knees, and debris.
Payload Capacity	Solo Driver + 150 lbs Gear (or 2-person short-trip)	Optimized for utility equipment, fuel, and specimen storage.

JOIN THE VOLUNTEER BUILD CREW

We are forming an LLC collective of python hunters, welders, mechanics, and conservationists to build an initial pilot batch of 4 mini-airboats. Sweat equity and task contributions are tracked transparently via fixed-estimate hour credits.

BATCH PRODUCTION & VOLUNTEER LOGIC

Collaborative Sweat Equity, Task Tracking, and Risk Mitigation

3. THE FIXED-ESTIMATE CREDIT SYSTEM

To ensure fairness and eliminate incentives for slow work, all fabrication tasks are assigned fixed-estimate hour credits based on the master build guide. Participants accumulate credit based on the task value, regardless of shop speed.

BUILD TASK CATEGORY	DIY SKILL TAG	PRO OUTSOURCE OPTION
Hull Prep & Armor	Riveting, Countersinking, UHMW Cutting	Submit receipt for material/shop work
Internal Framework	MIG / TIG Aluminum Welding	Fixed credit applied upon task completion
Engine & Rigging	Rotax 850 E-TEC Harness, Reduction Drive	Outsource allowed per master estimate rate
Steering & Controls	Stick Linkage, Console Fabrication	Pooled labor across all batch hulls

4. THE PROTOTYPE-TO-BATCH PRODUCTION MODEL

Phase 1: Prototype Gate

The Founding Organizer constructs and tests Prototype #1. The boat undergoes full field trials in Everglades conditions to validate stability, sightlines, cooling, and chine tracking.

Phase 2: Batch Production

Upon prototype sign-off, the volunteer team executes parallel assembly-line fabrication for the remaining 3 hulls. All boats must be 100% completed before any units are distributed.

5. RISK MANAGEMENT & PROTECTION

FAIL-SAFE LLC WIND-DOWN PROVISION

If prototype trials reveal unforeseen design or operational flaws that render the concept impractical, the LLC Operating Agreement dictates an orderly wind-down. All capital assets, unused materials, donor components, and hulls are liquidated, and proceeds are returned to members based on logged capital and labor credit ledger ratios.

6. HOW TO GET INVOLVED

Volunteers & Skilled Trades

We need aluminum welders, small engine mechanics, auto-electricians, and active python hunters. Pledges can cover a full boat share or fractional group shares.

GoFundMe Supporters

Help fund raw materials (aluminum sheet, Rotax donors, UHMW armor). Every dollar backed supports invasive species eradication in Florida's Everglades ecosystem.